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THE MALDIVES VARIOUS MILITARY ASSETS, ASTRUCTURE AND PROVIDED



FAST PATROL VESSEL 1
Delivered: May 2023

- Commissioned as MNDF Coast guard ship *Huravee*, it is capable of coastal and offshore surveillance at high speeds

LANDING CRAFT ASSAULT SHIP 1
Delivered: May 2023

- This is meant to bolster the country's defence preparedness against pirates and traffickers



DEFENCE INFRASTRUCTURE/ TRAINING

EXTENDED COASTAL SURVEILLANCE RADAR SYSTEM (CSRS)
Completed: 2022

- This will integrate information from 10 coastal radars across the country that India installed since 2007. Will augment MNDF's maritime surveillance



SENAHIYA MNDF MILITARY HOSPITAL
Completed: 2012

- India developed this small facility into a hospital and supplies it medical equipment

COMPOSITE TRAINING FACILITY
Completed: 2019

- The main training centre of the Maldives defence forces. India gave $1 million (Rs 8.33 cr) for developing its infrastructure, accommodation and training facilities



INDIA MALDIVES DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION

- Under a $1.4 billion economic package announced in 2018, India is helping develop the **Hanimadhoo** and Gan airports, the Gulhifalhu port, water and sewerage network on 34 islands, and building a cancer hospital and a cricket stadium. A national college for police and social housing projects have also been undertaken, along with the Greater Male connectivity project with bridges, causeways and roads

HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE

2004-2005 India was the first country to respond to the Maldives' needs during the 2004 tsunami

2014 Indian ships, aircraft delivered 2,000 tonnes of water to Maldives when it was gripped by a water crisis

2020 It provided 30,000 measles and rubella vaccines to prevent a national outbreak

2020-2021 India was again the first responder to Maldives during the Covid pandemic with vaccines and financial assistance of $250 million (Rs 2,083 crore)

Rajnath Singh visited Male and handed over a Fast Patrol Vessel and a Landing Craft Assault ship to the Maldives National Defence Force (MNDF) and laid the foundation stone for constructing the Ekatha Harbour at Uthuru Thila Falhu (UTF), an island near Male. The patrol vessel, capable of coastal and offshore surveillance at high speeds, was commissioned as the MNDF Coast Guard ship *Huravee*. The Ekatha Harbour is one of India's biggest grant-in-aid projects in the Maldives. India will help develop and maintain the harbour and provide technical/ logistical support for 15 years upon its completion. It will enable the MNDF to dock and repair its coast guard vessels.

The Maldives is strategically located in the Indian Ocean—an area where India and China are both keen to establish influence. It may have a land area of just 300 sq. km and a population of around 480,000, but it straddles a 960-km-long submarine ridge running north to south, which forms a wall in the middle of the Indian Ocean. Located at the